



SHOBU YARLAGADDA

CEO & CO-FOUNDER,
ARKA MEDIAWORKS

“Makkhi should have been the first pan-India film. That didn’t happen and it was a learning for us as to why it didn’t happen and that’s how we pushed the *Baahubali* films”



VIJAY KIRAGANDUR

CO-FOUNDER,
HOMBALE GROUP

“We believe in doing surveys. You cannot give whatever you like to the audience and make them watch it. You have to understand their behaviour, mindset and taste”



Y. RAVI SHANKAR

CO-FOUNDER,
MYTHRI MOVIE MAKERS

“We were clear that with our budgets, we would be able to recover the money in our core markets. Hindi was just trial and error... we were surprised by the success outside south India”

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make my story understood by more number of people? The automatic decision is to dub it into a language that other people understand. But that is not as simple as it sounds. I dubbed *RRR* into five languages. So, why didn’t I go into Gujarati? Rajasthani? Bengali? Punjabi?”

Simply put, a market has to be created. *RRR* worked in Hindi because the *Baahubali* team had already laid the groundwork. “Our main challenge was in the first part itself. How do we get the message across?” The second part, in comparison, was a cakewalk, says producer Yarlagadda. From getting a Facebook page up and running from day one of the shoot, releasing behind-the-scenes videos on Facebook and YouTube even as filming progressed, using Google Trends and other social media analytics to monitor traction, sending actors to colleges in Punjab and Kolkata to promote the film and boost viewership, presenting it at the Delhi Comic Con, and tying up with the Indian Railways to give out *Baahubali* teacups on select intercity routes, they went all out to engage with north Indian audiences. “Maharashtra and Mumbai and all are easier to penetrate. But as you go North to Punjab and the Hindi heartland, it takes a little longer,” says Yarlagadda, adding that at the

peak, 20 people worked in-house directly on marketing.

When the efforts paid off, it showed other film-makers what was possible. “It’s all thanks to Rajamouli and Yarlagadda for making pan-India films and giving us the confidence,” says Vijay Kiragandur, Co-founder of Hom bale Group, which produced the *KGF* movies. It was a meeting with Rajamouli in Bengaluru two months before *KGF1*’s release that set the ball rolling. They showed him an 8-10-minute show-reel cut of the film on an iPad, and he asked them to go pan-India. “People in Karnataka were saying we are spending more on marketing than production in *KGF1*. [His words] gave us the confidence to spend that much. Otherwise also we would have gone all out,

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**INDIA’S GROSS BOX OFFICE COLLECTIONS
DURING THE JAN-APR 2022 PERIOD,
HEADLINED BY *K.G.F: CHAPTER 2* AND *RRR***